

Section A—Page Eight

Play First Game Friday Against Albuquerque

Miners to Open 50-Game Slate

By MIKE PEMBERTON

Andy Cohen's U.T. El Paso baseball team gets off to an early start on a rugged 50-game slate next Friday.

The Miners open against Albuquerque University for a three game home stand at Dudley Field. The opener on Friday will be followed by a twin bill on Saturday.

THIS IS THE TEAM'S first year in the Western Athletic Conference and the Miners will be in a division with Arizona State, University of Arizona and New Mexico. Ex-national champs Arizona and Arizona State are always a tough bunch to crack.

Cohen, who in previous years, has relied on a strong hitting team, may have his strategy changed. He will go to what the legendary Connie Mack called the most important part of the game—pitching.

COHEN'S ACE will be senior lefty Lynn Hunt. Hunt dipped to a 7-4 mark a year ago after posting an 8-3 record with a 1.73 earned run average the previous season.

In support of Hunt will be Jess Lujan, Bill Diesselhorst, Don Wilson and imports Harry Milner and Marc Bombard.

COHEN feels the big surprise on the hill could come from Ron Jones. Jones was the tight end on the Miner football team this year and was also drafted by the Green Bay Packers.

"This guy could be a real surprise to us when he gets his arm into shape. The kid has lots of raw talent and I like the way he looks," Cohen said.

LUJAN FELL off last year

to a poor 1-5 season after posting an 8-3 mark the year before. Adding power on the hill will be transfers Bombard and Milner. Bombard, an ex-Eastwood hurler, came to UTEP after a stretch at San Angelo State. Milner is a Odessa transfer.

Cohen faces two problems in the hitting department but hopes this won't affect his game too much. The first is the fact he is staffing only two returning .300 hitters and the second is he has only one left-handed swinger in the lineup.

RETURNING with .300 plus averages are John Miller and Juan Sandoval. Milner swatted .348 and Sandoval had a .311 pace.

Adding to the bombing power will be hard-hitting Danny Blanco and catcher Ron Mix. Blanco, who usually stays around the .300 mark dropped to .276 last year and Hix came home with .267 average.

ONE ONE MAJOR shift is seen in the fielding position. With appearance of Larry Currie, who is that only lefty in the lineup, at first, Miller was moved to the outfield. Hopefully the move won't bother Miller, whom Cohen feels is the most 'versatile' player on the field.

The infield will be staffed with experience. At second base will be Sandoval, at short Ron Rush and at the hot box Blanco. Rush can also play in the outfield, but it is very doubtful with the lineup Cohen has in the pastures.

MILLER and transfer student Rick Butler head up fly chasing duties and will have assistance from Mike Ward, a .270 hitter last year. Support-

ing them will be John Murphy, and Sam and Bill McLelland.

Behind the plate will no doubt be Hix, and he will have help from another footballer, Dick Daugherty, and also from Dick Meyer and Rick Witt.

National Hockey League Standings

EAST				
	W	L	T	Pts.
Montreal	36	16	8	80
Boston	33	12	12	78
Detroit	29	22	9	67
New York	30	23	6	66
Toronto	26	19	11	63
Chicago	28	26	6	62

WEST				
	W	L	T	Pts.
St. Louis	32	17	12	76
Oakland	23	28	9	55
Los Angeles	20	31	6	46
Philadelphia	13	31	15	41
Minnesota	15	34	9	39
Pittsburgh	12	38	9	33

YESTERDAY'S RESULTS

Oakland 3, St. Louis 2
Only game scheduled.
Philadelphia at Montreal
Chicago at Toronto
Detroit at Pittsburgh
St. Louis at Los Angeles
Only games scheduled.

NBA Standings

EAST				
	W	L	Pct.	GB
Baltimore	47	17	.734	
Philadelphia	42	21	.667	4½
New York	44	23	.657	4½
Boston	38	25	.603	6½
Cincinnati	34	31	.523	13½
Detroit	26	40	.396	22
Milwaukee	19	45	.297	28

WEST				
	W	L	Pct.	GB
Los Angeles	43	23	.652	
Atlanta	41	27	.601	3
San Fran	32	34	.486	11
San Diego	27	37	.419	15
Chicago	26	40	.394	17
Seattle	24	43	.358	19½
Phoenix	14	51	.215	28½

YESTERDAY'S RESULTS

Chicago 130, Phoenix 121
Boston 124, Los Angeles 102
Philadelphia 115, Seattle 109
Only games scheduled.

TODAY'S GAMES

Milwaukee at Detroit
San Diego at New York
Boston at Phoenix
Phila. at San Fran.
Only games scheduled.